BAPS Swaminarayan Sanstha®
Satsang Development Committee
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Aksharpith Lead Seva Guidelines

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1. Objective

1.1. The objective of this document is:

1.1.1. to assist with better planning, coordination and execution of various Satsang development related activities

1.1.2. to have a uniform and more structured approach while performing seva

1.1.3. to provide further information about high level roles & responsibilities and streamline various processes

1.1.4. to clarify any doubts or misconceptions during seva

1.1.5. to build, maintain and increase Samp-Suhradbhav-Ekta

1.1.6. to earn Satpurush's rajipo

2. Vimarsh & Communication

2.1. Must attend monthly Pramukh Vimarsh

2.2. Any decisions discussed during Pramukh Vimarsh, Aksharpith Lead to discuss and explain to respective Team Members to start planning for the project / event

2.3. Keep Services Admin in loop (FYI) for any action item and provide any updates in Pramukh Vimarsh

2.4. Keep Services Admin in loop (FYI) for any guidance or significant updates received from National Aksharpith Team and Local Vicharan P. Santo

2.5. Must attend any meetings organised by National Aksharpith Team to get necessary guidance and information regarding doing better planning and execution of Aksharpith seva

2.6. If for any genuine reason, Aksharpith Lead is unable to attend a national meeting, Aksharpith Lead must discuss with Services Admin to nominate another volunteer from local Aksharpith Team to attend the meeting on his behalf and get updates from that volunteer after the meeting and take necessary actions based on that meeting while keeping Services Admin in loop.

3. Team Development

3.1. Lead by example by remaining physically present during seva and provide necessary support and build rapport with team members

3.2. Encourage his respective Team Members' Growth / Development and build Samp amongst volunteers as per Bapa's ruchi.

3.3. Appreciate any constructive ideas received from Team Members and then discuss with Services Admin and further with Mandir / Centre Coordinator (CO), Local Vicharan P. Santo and National Aksharpith Team if required before any implementation.
3.4. Appreciate Team Members' good qualities during seva (commitment, sincerity, dedication, exceptional seva, etc.) in front of P. Santo and other volunteers in Vimarsh. This will encourage volunteers to perform their seva better.
3.5. Plan any seva well in advance in such a way to get maximum team members' availability to get their support.

4. Financial Expenses Process

4.1. Can authorise any new expenses up to $150 at his own discretion.
4.2. Discuss and get pre-authorisation from Services Admin for any expense incurred by his respective Team and submit the expense claim voucher along with supporting invoices as per Accounting Process so the Accounts Team can process any payments on time (1 week).
4.3. Already approved recurring expenses need not require any pre-authorisation every time.

5. Seva Changes and New Appointment

5.1. Discuss any Team Member seva changes with Services Admin and further with CO and Local Vicharan P. Santo if required and then send an appreciation message for old volunteer and welcome message for new volunteer in respective team members' seva group and only after that make any changes in the group.

6. Conflict Resolution

6.1. For any conflicts or issues amongst Team Members and with other departments, Aksharpith Lead to discuss with Services Admin to try to build and maintain Samp and if required discuss with CO / Local Vicharan P. Santo before making any decision.

7. Ordering & Stock Take

7.1. Place new orders well in advance as per National Aksharpith Team's guidance and order cycle as well as local Centre's requirements while keeping Services Admin in loop

Aksharpith:

7.2. Centres will be able to place their order twice in a year in January and July.
7.3. Whilst placing orders Aksharpith Lead to forecast requirements for seasonal events and festivals.
7.4. Stock Ordered In:
  7.4.1. January should last till October - Winter, Diwali, etc.
  7.4.2. July should last till May - Summer, Patotsav, Satsang Exams, etc.

7.5. Stock takes should be carried out at the end of March, June, September and December and reported to National Aksharpith Team when requested.

Herbal:

7.6. Centres will be able to place their order twice in a year in November and May.
7.7. National Aksharpith Team will send packing slip 3-5 days before the arrival of goods.
7.8. Inform Pujari (wherever applicable) or responsible storage karyakar about the goods arriving so can keep Mandir or storage area open.
7.9. When the goods arrive, Aksharpith Lead to verify the stock received against the order placed and raise any variance or damage with National Aksharpith Team using the Aksharpith Contact Us form within 1 week of the receipt of the stock.
7.10. Keep necessary records of any incident, expired products, product enquiries, wastage, theft and damages and send to National Aksharpith Team within 1 week.
7.11. Provide any support at Parasabha level for any Aksharpith related requirement in Parasabha while keeping Parasabha Sanchalak, Parasabha Satsang Admin (PSA) and Services Admin in loop
7.12. Stock takes should be carried out at the end of March, June, September and December.
7.13. Ensure store room is kept neat and tidy and all stock is accounted for.

8. Sales & Display

8.1. Ensure Aksharpith items display is presentable (on noticeboard, in bookstall, etc.) to boost up more sales.
8.2. Make sure the shelves in the bookstall never look empty.
8.3. Communicate and train Pujari on how to sell items and process payment when Aksharpith team members are not present at the Mandir.
8.4. From time to time, spread out marketing / promotional material provided by National Aksharpith Team to only Karyakars WhatsApp Group or similar.
8.5. Only use Hike POS system or any other National Aksharpith Team approved system for any selling as per the National Aksharpith Team guidance.
8.6. Make sure all the hardware and software is working properly and take assistance from local IT Team if required
8.7. For any expiring items, put them on sale with the help of National Aksharpith Team while keeping Services Admin in loop.
8.8. Do not sale any expired items. Discard them completely and report back to the National Aksharpith Team.
8.9. Assist COPR Team, Sant Utara, Sant Vicharan, Regional Mandals and other teams for any Aksharpith items requirement (e.g. Kanthi, Mala, Murti, Books, Puja, etc.) by following inter-department transfer process as per the guidance from National Aksharpith Team.

8.10. Ensure any money received (cash and via EFTPOS) is handed over to Mandir / Centre Accounts Team on a weekly basis along with its settlement (hisab).
8.11. If possible, only use bags provided by National Aksharpith Team.
8.12. Keep enough quantity of bags on hand and place additional bags order well in advance to the National Aksharpith Team.
8.13. Make sure all fittings and fixtures in the bookstall are working properly.

9. Other Notes

9.1. Aksharpith e-Store will be completely managed by the National Aksharpith Team. For any further information, contact National Aksharpith Team.
9.2. It is Aksharpith Lead's responsibility to keep Services Admin in loop.
9.3. Guidelines and information provided in this document is not extensive. Additional guidelines and / or information will be provided through various formal and informal channels (written, through meetings, in person, over the phone or virtually) as and when deemed necessary under P. Santo and BAPS ANZ National Team's guidance.

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